

HOUSE No. 3565

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

PRESENTED BY:

Amy Mah Sangiolo

To the Honorable Senate and House of Representatives of the Commonwealth of Massachusetts in General Court assembled:

The undersigned legislators and/or citizens respectfully petition for the adoption of the accompanying bill:

An Act relative to Mass Save assessments.

PETITION OF:

NAME:	DISTRICT/ADDRESS:	DATE ADDED:
<i>Amy Mah Sangiolo</i>	<i>11th Middlesex</i>	<i>1/16/2025</i>
<i>James C. Arena-DeRosa</i>	<i>8th Middlesex</i>	<i>4/9/2025</i>
<i>Michael D. Brady</i>	<i>Second Plymouth and Norfolk</i>	<i>1/28/2025</i>
<i>Mike Connolly</i>	<i>26th Middlesex</i>	<i>3/20/2025</i>
<i>Marjorie C. Decker</i>	<i>25th Middlesex</i>	<i>6/26/2025</i>
<i>Carmine Lawrence Gentile</i>	<i>13th Middlesex</i>	<i>10/12/2025</i>
<i>Tara T. Hong</i>	<i>18th Middlesex</i>	<i>3/12/2025</i>
<i>Vanna Howard</i>	<i>17th Middlesex</i>	<i>5/7/2025</i>
<i>Patrick Joseph Kearney</i>	<i>4th Plymouth</i>	<i>1/28/2025</i>
<i>John J. Lawn, Jr.</i>	<i>10th Middlesex</i>	<i>12/8/2025</i>
<i>Margaret R. Scarsdale</i>	<i>1st Middlesex</i>	<i>10/14/2025</i>

HOUSE No. 3565

By Representative Sangiolo of Newton, a petition (accompanied by bill, House, No. 3565) of Amy Mah Sangiolo, Michael D. Brady and Patrick Joseph Kearney relative to Mass Save assessments. Telecommunications, Utilities and Energy.

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

In the One Hundred and Ninety-Fourth General Court
(2025-2026)

An Act relative to Mass Save assessments.

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Court assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows:

1 Amend Chapter 25 by adding a new subsection (g)

2 Said section 21 of said chapter 25, as amended by chapter 179 of the Acts of 2022, is
3 hereby further amended by inserting at the end thereof the following:-

4 SECTION 1. Section 21 of chapter 25 ..., as amended by chapter 179 of the Acts of
5 2022, is hereby amended by adding the following subsections:

6 (h) The administrators of the programs established pursuant to section 19 of this chapter
7 shall (i) offer to a customer at no cost a zero-carbon assessment of such customer's building,
8 including a heat load calculation, that identifies measures that a customer must take to heat or
9 cool such building without the use of combustible fuels and (ii) identify rebates and incentives
10 available under such programs to assist a customer in implementing measures identified by such
11 assessment. Measures identified in a zero-carbon assessment may include, but shall not be
12 limited to: improving building shell insulation; air sealing; air duct sealing; improving air

exchange and indoor air quality; upgrading windows, doors, and cladding systems; electric wiring and service upgrades; on site solar generation; electrical or thermal storage; electric peak load management equipment and software; and replacing fossil fuel appliances and equipment with electric or otherwise non-combusting appliances and equipment. A zero-carbon assessment shall include a safety evaluation including a combustion safety test of existing fossil fuel appliances, an instrumented test for ambient gas and particularly for gas leaks at the gas meter, and a test of existing carbon monoxide alarms. A customer whose building has undergone a zero-carbon assessment shall be provided with a zero-carbon report that identifies for each measure that reduces emissions additional benefits including, but not limited to: (i) improvements in comfort, safety, and health, including indoor air quality; (ii) cost savings; and (iii) any other information the program administrators determine to be necessary to include. The zero-carbon report shall include at least one scenario incorporating a combination of efficiency measures, replacement of gas appliances with non-emitting appliances, on site solar energy and electrical storage which takes advantage of available promotional electric rates, income eligible electric rates and utility offerings for off peak and peak avoiding incentives to reduce projected client energy expenditures. The Massachusetts energy technology center shall develop the zero-carbon assessment and the zero-carbon report in consultation with the program administrators and the energy efficiency advisory council established pursuant to section 22 of this chapter. The commonwealth shall retain rights to the use of the zero-carbon assessment, the zero-carbon report, and any associated data and software for use by Mass Save or any successor organization. The zero-carbon assessment shall be the standard assessment service available to all customers receiving services provided pursuant to this section.

SECTION 2. Section 21 of chapter 25 of the General Laws, as amended by chapter 179 of the Acts of 2022, is hereby amended, in clause (xiv) of paragraph (2) of subsection (b) by striking out “, delineated by utility and sector, including residential, residential low-income, commercial and industrial” and inserting in place thereof the following:-

”; provided, that the data collected pursuant to subclauses (A), (B), and (C) shall be delineated by utility and sector, including residential, residential low-income, commercial and industrial, and zip code”

SECTION 3. Said section 21 of said chapter 25, as amended by chapter 179 of the Acts of 2022, is hereby further amended by inserting at the end thereof the following:-

“(h) The electric distribution companies, municipal aggregators with certified efficiency plans, and the natural gas distribution companies shall no later than March 31 of each year provide to the department the data that is collected pursuant to clause (xiv) of paragraph (2) of subsection

(b) of this section during the previous calendar year. The department shall publish such data on the website of the energy efficiency advisory council no later than April 30 of each year.”

(i) The administrators of the programs established pursuant to section 19 of this chapter shall establish criteria to determine qualifications of contractors approved to install recommendations of the zero-carbon assessment authorized pursuant to subsection (h) of this section, including mitigation and remediation of barriers identified in such zero-carbon assessment. Such contractors approved to install such recommendations shall agree (i) to meet program and industry standards; (ii) to warrant their work for at least 12 months after completion

of their work; (iii) to undergo quality assurance assessments of their work; and (iv) to require their employees and subcontractors to participate in periodic training programs and to adhere to program goals and standards as determined by such program administrators. In assembling lists of contractors approved to install recommendations of such zero-carbon assessments, such program administrators shall award preference to qualified businesses owned by women or by minorities [cite to statute defining those] and to qualified businesses located in or serving environmental justice communities [cite to statute defining those]. Such program administrators shall whenever feasible procure cost savings for customers through purchases in bulk of appliances and other equipment necessary for decarbonization of buildings.

(j) Such program administrators shall develop (i) consulting programs to advise building owners undertaking projects to replace fossil fuel appliances and equipment with electric or otherwise non-combusting appliances and to upgrade and retrofit buildings as proposed in a zero carbon report; and (ii) training programs for participating staff, contractors, and volunteers that cover program procedures, costs and benefits of electrification of buildings, incentives available by electrification of buildings.

(k) Such program administrators shall report annually no later than March 31 on results achieved by the programs established pursuant to this section to the governor and to the clerks of the house of representatives and the senate, who shall forward such reports to the president of the senate, the speaker of the house of representatives, and the chairs of the joint committee on telecommunications, utilities, and energy.

(l) The department shall within 12 months of the effective date of this section promulgate such rules and regulations as are necessary to administer the requirements of this section.

79 SECTION __. Section 1 shall take effect upon its passage and shall apply to energy
80 efficiency plans beginning with the plan that covers the years 2025 to 2027.